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MAZE OF ALGORITHM

Cleaning up the digital space

The NCPDR has summoned Meta officials over child sexual abuse content in Instagram

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Tata Sons should go public immediately: RBI

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Trinamool groups meet EC over name, symbol

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India meets Sri Lanka in Asia Cup final

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BRICS bridges Iran-UAE divide, adopts New Delhi Declaration

Last-minute compromise on language about war in West Asia enables a consensus in the bloc, declaration calls for 'maximum restraint' in war with no specific mention of strikes; it rebukes Israel and calls for humanitarian aid to Gaza

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

India forged a consensus of BRICS countries on Saturday, after Iran and the United Arab Emirates agreed to a last-minute compromise on the language used about the war in West Asia, allowing the 11-member grouping to adopt the New Delhi Declaration at a meeting chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

The statement, which did not directly mention the attacks against Iran by the United States and Israel nor Iran's subsequent strikes on its Persian Gulf neighbours, including the UAE, called for "maximum restraint" in the war. It made no separate mention of the Russian war in Ukraine.

The meeting was attended by the leaders of eight member countries, including Russian President Vladimir Putin, Chinese President Xi Jinping, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, and the leaders of Indonesia, Ethiopia, Egypt, and South Africa. Brazil and the UAE sent high-level representatives.

Significantly, given India's close ties with Israel and Mr. Modi's own visit to Jerusalem in February, the grouping declared its strong criticism of the country for its bombardment of Gaza. It expressed support for South Africa's case against Israel in international courts, calling for the provision of humani-

Common ground

The New Delhi Declaration adopted at the 18th BRICS summit reaffirmed members' commitment to the bloc's spirit of mutual respect, sovereign equality, and democracy

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

- Iran, UAE back down from tough positions as text on West Asia omits direct references to U.S.-Israel attack on Iran and Iran attack on UAE

- Support for Palestinian state and strong 8-para criticism of Israel for strikes on Gaza and Lebanon, and displacement of Palestinians

- It condemns imposition of unilateral coercive measures like tariffs and sanctions

- Call for comprehensive reform of UN, support for greater role for Brazil, India in UNSC

- Support for BRICS trade mechanisms, including intra-BRICS payments through national currencies

- It strongly condemns terrorism in all forms, including the 2025 Pahalgaam attack

tarian aid in Gaza.

The New Delhi declaration called for "comprehensive reform" of the United Nations, including support for Brazil and India to get a bigger role in the Security Council. It also stressed the need to protect civilians and expressed "deep concern" over attacks on civilian infrastructure and nuclear facilities in West Asia, in reference to the U.S. and Israel's missile strikes in Iran.

Addressing the leaders, Mr. Modi said that 20 years after the grouping of emerging economies was originally formed, BRICS was "coming of age" with a "distinct identity" not aimed against others on the global stage. "We respect each other's perspectives and move forward through consensus. We strive to move ahead with an approach that is not against anyone but instead seeks to take everyone along," the Prime Minister

said, in a possible reference to the criticism of BRICS in the U.S. as an "anti-western" grouping.

Mr. Modi suggested that BRICS build a "troika" system like the G-20, so incoming and outgoing Presidents of the grouping bring continuity to discussions. He also proposed a road map for global governance reform, a seafarer distress network, and a BRICS global south mechanism for skill development in new technologies. Chinese President Xi Jinping, who held an hour-long bilateral meeting with Mr. Modi after the session, announced that China would take over the presidency of BRICS for the next year. The grouping had become the "world's most influential platform for cooperation among emerging markets and developing countries," he said.

The declaration also criticised the U.S. blockade of Cuba, and expressed

concern over violence in Sudan.

Previous ministerial meetings of BRICS this year had failed to issue joint statements on the Iran-UAE tussle. Sources privy to the negotiations said that Iran had wanted a strong condemnation of the U.S. and Israel for starting the war with strikes that assassinated its Supreme Leader, similar to the statement issued by the SCO grouping, which does not include the UAE. The UAE wanted "equal condemnation" of Iran's attacks against its neighbours. Eventually, the text agreed to include non-specific references to the conflict.

'Months of discussions'

The consensus was achieved through months of "threadbare" discussions, according to Sudhakar Dalela, Indian Sherpa at the talks and Secretary (Economic Relations) in the Ministry of External Af-

Modi makes a strong pitch for global reform

NEW DELHI

Highlighting the current imbalance between decision-makers and those impacted by their decisions, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday made a strong pitch for global reform and called for BRICS to transition from "rule-takers to rule-shapers". » PAGE 5

fairs. He was addressing a media briefing after the closed BRICS session on the future of global governance and strengthening multilateralism. Side-stepping a question from *The Hindu* on whether India had asked for support from other leaders in BRICS to help convince Iran and UAE to agree to the draft language, he said that the cooperation and collaboration of all members was "key".

He also underlined BRICS countries' consensus against cross-border terrorism, with a specific reference to the Pahalgaam terror attack in 2025.

On Sunday, Mr. Modi will chair a session of BRICS Plus countries and regional representatives for an outreach session that will include the leaders of Malaysia, Uzbekistan, Uganda, Vietnam, and Kazakhstan.

DETAILED COVERAGE ON » PAGES 4 & 5

Xi, Modi welcome 'steady progress' in India-China ties

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday met Chinese President Xi Jinping on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi, where the two leaders welcomed the "steady progress" in India-China relations since their last meeting in August 2025.

"We reviewed the full range of India-China relations. Also conveyed best wishes for China's BRICS presidency that commences next year," said Mr. Modi in a message after the meeting.

"The two leaders welcomed the steady progress in India-China bilateral relations since their last meeting in Tianjin in August 2025. They reaffirmed that both countries should take a strategic and long-term perspective of their ties. Differences should not become disputes," the External Affairs Ministry said in a statement after the talks. Mr. Modi stressed the importance of "peace and tranquillity" in the border areas, describing the matter as an "essential basis for development of bilateral relations".

Chinese State media reported that Mr. Xi said the two states have "different national circumstances", but "China and India can learn from each other's strengths and achieve shared development".

Mr. Xi outlined four points on how to ensure the long-term, steady development of India-China relations and emphasised "rational strategic understanding", "cooperation through mutual benefit", "mutual respect and un-

Prime Minister Narendra Modi greets Chinese President Xi Jinping on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi on Saturday. PTI

derstanding", and "openness and inclusiveness through multilateral cooperation" in the UN, SCO, BRICS, and G-20.

The External Affairs Ministry said the two leaders expressed their commitment to "a fair, reasonable and mutually acceptable resolution of the boundary question", proceeding from the political perspective of their overall bilateral relations and the long-term interests of the two peoples.

"They (India and China) should pursue progress on bilateral relations and the boundary question in parallel, ensuring that each supports the other, and maintain peace and tranquillity in border areas," a statement from the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of China said.

Mr. Xi arrived with a large delegation earlier in the day for a two-day visit and was driven to the summit venue at Bharat Mandapam amid tight security.

'Political settlement'

Speaking at the summit on the situation in West Asia,

Mr. Xi said the war has inflicted "serious losses" on the people of all countries in the region, and it is against the common interests of the international community. Chinese Foreign Ministry Spokesperson Mao Ning, referring to Mr. Xi's speech, called for a "political settlement" of the crisis. "China will work with fellow BRICS members to play a due role in bringing peace and tranquillity to the Middle East," said Mr. Xi, referring to India and China as "key members of the Global South".

"We must keep the future of humanity and the well-being of our people at heart, join hands to drive high-quality cooperation within the expanded BRICS framework, advocate for an orderly multipolar world and an economic globalisation that is universally beneficial and inclusive, and inject greater positive energy into promoting global peace, stability, development, and prosperity," he said.

(With inputs from Ananth Krishnan in Beijing)

INSIDE

T.N. CM flags off Silverstone motor race in the U.K.

LONDON Tamil Nadu CM C. Joseph Vijay flagged off the Michelin Le Mans Cup at the Silverstone circuit in Northampton, U.K., on Saturday evening. He also spent time with actor and motorsports racer Ajith Kumar, posing with him at the venue and in the race car. » PAGE 2

Anthropic calls for slowdown of AI development

NEW YORK

Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei called on AI companies to slow the rate at which they advance model capabilities amid safety concerns, outlining a three-step framework intended to pace development and create more time to manage its risks. » PAGE 12

NIA court issues arrest warrant against LeT chief

Peerzada Ashiq
JAMMU

A special National Investigation Agency (NIA) court in Jammu has issued a non-bailable arrest warrant against Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) founder Hafiz Muhammad Saeed in a case related to "providing weapons, money and directions to terrorists operating in the Kashmir Valley".

"Keeping in view that the investigating agency has not been able to procure his attendance ordinarily, this motion is allowed. As such, a general warrant of arrest [non-bailable] is issued against the accused...", the court said in its order.

The order came after the NIA moved an application for issuing a non-bailable warrant under Section 75 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) against him.

According to the Central agency, the "amir/chief/founder of the proscribed terrorist organisation LeT was operating from Pakis-

Wanted terrorist: LeT founder Hafiz Saeed is at present in Pakistan and is deliberately evading arrest to escape the law, says NIA. AP

tan and providing weapons, money, and directions to terrorists operating in the Kashmir Valley". "The information is that the said terrorist is at present in Pakistan and is deliberately evading arrest to escape from the clutches of the law. Therefore, the NIA prays for the issuance of a non-bailable warrant of arrest against him," the NIA said.

The agency referred to a case registered this year in which a person was arrested during checking at Gujar Tent Pandah in Ganderbal by the J&K Police.

"During a personal

search of the rider, one Chinese grenade and 15 live rounds and cartridges were recovered from him. On preliminary questioning, the said person disclosed his name as Mohammad Nageeb Bhat, a resident of Fazaal Haq Colony, Batpora, Srinagar. He failed to produce any valid justification for possessing the arms and ammunition," the NIA said. "During the investigation conducted so far, it came to light that the arrested Pakistani terrorist has been found to be associated with LeT/The Resistance Front," the NIA said.

Saudi Arabia shuts down oil pipeline as Houthis tighten grip on Red Sea

Reuters
ADEN/DUBAI

Saudi Arabia has shut down its East-West pipeline after the vital oil conduit came under aerial attack in the widening West Asia war, threatening to send energy prices even higher.

The world's largest crude oil exporter temporarily closed the pipeline after a drone attack that both Baghdad and Riyadh said had originated in Iraq, where Iranian-backed militias operate. Iraq dismissed a military commander on Saturday in response to the attack.

The 1,200-km pipeline running across the Arabian Peninsula had helped Saudi Arabia bypass a shipping logjam in the Strait of Hormuz, where tanker traffic has slowed to a trickle due to the six-month war between the U.S. and Iran.

The Saudi Energy Ministry said it had shut the pipeline as a precaution. The line had been moving 4-5 million barrels a day in re-

An infrastructure site after it was damaged by fire southeast of Medina along the route of Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline. AFP

cent months, amounting to 4-5% of global supply.

There was no immediate claim of responsibility for the strikes. Satellite images showed black smoke rising from an area of the pipeline south of Medina. The attack resulted in some injuries and damage that was being assessed,

the Saudi Foreign Ministry said. U.S. President Donald Trump, visiting Ireland to attend a golf tournament at one of his resorts, said Iran was probably to blame for the attack. The war he launched six months ago

would probably end shortly after the U.S. midterm elections in November, when oil prices would "come tumbling down", he added.

The Houthis seized the strategic island of Perim on Friday at the mouth of the Red Sea, in the Bab el-Mandeb strait.

Saudi Arabia's de facto ruler, Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, phoned Mr. Trump last week and asked for U.S. military help fighting the Houthis, two sources told Reuters. He was told Wash-

ington would not intervene directly for now but would help with intelligence, the sources said.

Mr. Trump confirmed on Saturday he had spoken to the Crown Prince, and said the Houthis had also phoned his administration and asked for Washington not to become directly involved in the conflict.

The dual attacks reported on Friday — on the pipeline and Perim Island — could represent a dangerous escalation while diplomatic efforts to end the war have stalled. Saudi crude pumped through the pipeline to the Red Sea has been the main alternative source of West Asia oil while access to the Gulf has been cut off throughout the war.

Plan for counterattack

Meanwhile, Saudi-backed forces of the Yemeni government based in the south of the country indicated they would try to retake areas captured this week in the lightning offensive by the Houthis.

CM

K

A B X

Nearly 290
videos found
in devices
seized from
Pragathi cell

The Hindu
Kerala

The search of the mobile phones and other electronic devices of the arrested persons in the Pragathi cell has yielded nearly 290 videos, which are being analysed by the police. The videos are being analysed by the police to identify the persons who are involved in the Pragathi cell. The police are also analysing the videos to identify the persons who are involved in the Pragathi cell. The police are also analysing the videos to identify the persons who are involved in the Pragathi cell.

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Charges by ED reflect shared agenda of Cong., BJP: Pinarayi

Opposition leader says ED and Congress target by the union through its anti-corruption drive

The Hindu
Kerala

L... The charges by the ED reflect the shared agenda of the Congress and the BJP, Pinarayi said. He said that the charges are being filed against the persons who are involved in the Pragathi cell. He said that the charges are being filed against the persons who are involved in the Pragathi cell.



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Complainant in ED case has Congress links: Lokesh

The Hindu
Kerala

Lokesh said that the complainant in the ED case has Congress links. He said that the complainant is a person who is involved in the Pragathi cell. He said that the complainant is a person who is involved in the Pragathi cell.



TN Chief Minister flags off Silverstone motor race in the UK

The Hindu
Kerala

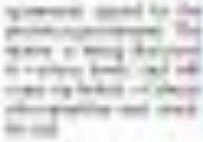
The Tamil Nadu Chief Minister, J Jayalalitha, flagged off the Silverstone motor race in the UK. She said that the race is being held in the UK. She said that the race is being held in the UK.

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Keralam still on the fence over PM SHRI scheme

The Hindu
Kerala

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Power crisis triggers fresh blame game in Keralam



Assembly passes bill to fund modernisation of

The assembly has passed a bill to fund the modernisation of the roads in Keralam. The bill is being passed by the assembly.

A.P. Assembly building

The assembly building in A.P. is being built by the government. The building is being built by the government.

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Power crisis triggers fresh blame game in Keralam

The Hindu
Kerala

The power crisis in Keralam has triggered a fresh blame game. The power crisis is being caused by the government.



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A.P. MedTech Zone to drive BRICS BioDesign initiative

The Hindu
Kerala

The A.P. MedTech Zone is being built by the government. The zone is being built by the government.



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Arm theft case: police to seek custody of ex-husband

The Hindu
Kerala

The police are seeking the custody of the ex-husband of the woman who was involved in the arm theft case. The police are seeking the custody of the ex-husband.

Karnataka SIR leaves vulnerable families in a bind

The Hindu
Kerala

The Karnataka SIR has left the vulnerable families in a bind. The SIR has left the families in a bind.



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There is also a strong case to be made that the U.S. national interest is best served by the foreign policy of the Republican Party. The Republican Party is the only party in the United States that is not opposed to the U.S. national interest. The Republican Party is the only party in the United States that is not opposed to the U.S. national interest.

High water: <http://www.water.gov.au/water-for-people/urban-water-use/rooftop-water-harvesting/>

Infected devices require repair, upgrade, and replacement, while the FBI's incident response unit must coordinate with forensic investigators and analysts to prevent further damage, mitigate damage, and contain the incident. The FBI's incident response unit must also coordinate with the FBI's incident response unit to ensure that the incident is properly handled and that the incident is properly handled.

News in Frames



1. A small, ornate, golden-colored shrine or religious structure with a domed top and intricate carvings.



2. A close-up of a green wooden door with a large, ornate metal lock and handle.



3. A view of a dirt road or path in a rural area, with a small, simple building or structure in the background.



A village with no people

It is a village with no people, but it is a village with a story. The story of a village that has been abandoned for decades, and the reasons why.



Author's name and title

It is a village with no people, but it is a village with a story. The story of a village that has been abandoned for decades, and the reasons why.

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Caption for the image of the traditional house.

News in Frames



Art gallery A room with several framed pictures on the wall.



Woman A woman in a white headscarf standing in front of a green building.



Communication tower A tall communication tower in a rural landscape.



Walking A woman and a young girl walking on a paved road.



Satellite dish A satellite dish on a roof.



Village A view of a village from a hill.

Why are bank employees striking despite the PLI pause?

This article appears in the 2018 FAQ. What is the other 2018 FAQ? For details, see the FAQ.

CCA, Bank Employees

The story is

The government recently announced that it was pausing the PLI (Production Linked Incentive) scheme for a year. This move has led to a strike by bank employees, who are demanding a 10% hike in their salaries.

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Why has the Census been deferred in Manipur?

The Census of India is a major exercise in the country, which is conducted every 10 years. The Census of India is a major exercise in the country, which is conducted every 10 years.

Background

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A group of people, likely census workers, are seen in a field, possibly conducting a census in Manipur.

Why?

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What's the impact?

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Why is NCPCR investigating Meta, Instagram?

The NCPCR (National Commission for Protection of Child Rights) is a body set up by the Government of India to protect the rights of children. The NCPCR is a body set up by the Government of India to protect the rights of children.

Background

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